Pharmacy Students' Perception and Knowledge of Chat-based Artificial Intelligence Tools at a Nigerian University

E. Ali, B. Wang, P. Martin, C. Park, H. Lin
J. Khalid, D. Le, E.J. Hoffmann, M.J. Coleman, H. Saleh
D.J. Robinson, O. Harris, C.J. Fischer

Abstract

Chat-based Artificial Intelligence (AI) tools, such as ChatGPT®, are becoming integral to various aspects of pharmacy education. However, their integration into the curriculum faces challenges due to students' varying levels of knowledge and perceptions. This study aimed to evaluate pharmacy students' knowledge and perception of chat-based AI tools at Afe Babalola University, Ado-Ekiti, Nigeria (ABUAD). It also assessed their familiarity with these tools and their usage patterns. A cross-sectional online survey was conducted from March to April 2024 among undergraduate pharmacy students, selected through random sampling. Student knowledge was categorised as good or poor while perception was grouped into positive or negative. Data analysis was conducted using Statistical Product and Service Solutions version 27. A total of 252 students participated in this study with the majority being female (72.2%). Most students (88%, n=222) were familiar with chat-based AI tools, with ChatGPT® being the most commonly used (82.8%) for assignments and studying. Students generally showed a positive perception of the tools, with 85.3% believing it enhances academic performance. Concerns were raised about potential distractions (65.7%) and the risk of academic dishonesty (65.1%). Students with prior AI education ($p<0.001$), higher levels of study ($p=0.011$), and prior awareness ($p<0.001$) demonstrated significantly higher knowledge scores. Pharmacy students at ABUAD demonstrated good knowledge of chat-based AI tools and generally positive perceptions towards its use. The study underscores the need to integrate AI education into the pharmacy curriculum to address knowledge gaps and better prepare students for future technological advancements.